UNIVERSITY OF THE
WITWATERSRAND,
JOHANNESBURG

Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical)
FWA Registered No IRB 00001223

SECRETARIAT: Suite 189, Private Bag x2600, Houghton 2041, South Africa Tel: +27-11-274 9200 Fax: +27-11-274 9281

EMAILED

28 June 2022

Prof MF Chersich,

Wits RHI Head Quarters
Hillbrow Health Precinct
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2001

Email: mchersich@wrhi.ac.za

CC: Mr CJ Parker
Wits RHI - Esselen Street
Hugh Solomon Building
Hillbrow Health Precinct, 22 Esselen Stre
Hillbrow
2001

Email: cparker@wrhi.ac.za

Dear Prof Chersich,

PROTOCOL: HEAT001 : INDIVIDUAL PARTICIPANT DATA META-ANALYSIS TO QUANTIFY THE IMPACT OF HIGH AMBIENT TEMPERATURES ON MATERNAL AND CHILD HEALTH IN AFRICA

RE: ASSESSORS QUERIES

REFERENCE NO: 220605

Please would you be so kind as to respond to the following queries raised regarding the above Protocol:

1. AT THE RECENT HUMAN RESEARCH ETHICS COMMITTEE: (MEDICAL) (HREC) meeting held on 24 June 2022, the committee agreed that the above-mentioned study can be approved. There were no points that required clarification.

Your response to the above queries raised would be appreciated on or before 18 July 2022.

Yours sincerely

MRS KIM ZARA MOTHIBA

For and on behalf of the Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical)

1. 15 JUNE 2022 - HEREWITH SUMMARY OF REVIEW AND QUERIES RAISED BY ETHICS ASSESSOR, PROF C SMITH - TEL: 011 488 3487

SUMMARY OF REVIEW
This is a secondary data analysis study based on individual impact data to be drawn from multiple sites. The aim is to quantify the impact of high ambient temperatures on maternal and child health in sub-Africa.

The study forms parts of DS-I Africa which aims to make optimum use of existing data resources across Africa to address the most pressing health concerns on the continent. The study constitutes one of two research projects within the HEat and HEalth African Transdisciplinary Center (HE2AT Center) project funded through the DS-I Africa Program.

To be eligible, studies need to have collected longitudinal data, have enrolled at least 1000 pregnant women from sub-Saharan Africa in the period January 2000 to June 2022, have collected data on key outcomes of the review, and have relevant ethics approvals in place.

At an individual level, participants need to have been recruited during pregnancy or intrapartum and have data available on date of birth and location.

We will obtain data from open sources, data repositories or through a collaboration with investigators or data holders from eligible studies.

The individual datasets will be harmonised through the recoding of raw individual participant data into a common set of variables.

A one and/or two-stage analysis method will be adopted whereby, in the first-stage, each study is analysed individually. Then, in the second stage, the data from the individual studies are aggregated to provide a pooled estimate of effect.

Risk to a participant in this study are minimal as there are no new procedures involved and many steps will be taken to protect their personal information. Data from participants will be safeguarded and only made available to the study investigators through strict access control platforms. Personal identifying information such as date of birth or address will further, only be made available to a smaller subset of investigators who will be responsible for anonymising the data through various methods. Moreover, no persona; details of any participant will be made publicly available through this project or published in a journal article.

There are no pints that require clarification.

IN VIEW OF THE ABOVE, PROF SMITH RECOMMENDS THAT THE PROTOCOL BE APPROVED

Your response to the above queries raised would be appreciated on or before 18 July 2022.

Yours sincerely

MRS KIM ZARA MOTHIBA

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22 June 2022

Prof MF Chersich,

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CC: Mr CJ Parker
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Email: cparker@wrhi.ac.za

Dear Prof Chersich,

PROTOCOL: HEAT001 : INDIVIDUAL PARTICIPANT DATA META-ANALYSIS TO QUANTIFY THE IMPACT OF HIGH AMBIENT TEMPERATURES ON MATERNAL AND CHILD HEALTH IN AFRICA

RE: ASSESSORS QUERIES

REFERENCE NO: 220605

Please would you be so kind as to respond to the following queries raised regarding the above Protocol:

1. 21 JUNE 2022 - HEREWITH SUMMARY OF REVIEW AND QUERIES RAISED BY ETHICS ASSESSOR, PROF RGM THOM - TEL: 011 350 0079

   SUMMARY OF REVIEW: The aim of this project is to use innovative data science approaches to quantify the current and future impacts of heat exposure on maternal and child health in sub-Saharan Africa. This will be a secondary analysis of existing data. Individual participant data will be collected from studies conducted between January 2000 and June 2022 and will be aggregated to perform meta-analyses. Inclusion criteria include studies with over 1000 participants with data collected over a period of time (i.e. prospective cohort studies of pregnant women and birth outcomes. Variables extracted from these studies will be mapped against environmental data to determine the health impacts of climate change. Permission to access information from existing databases will be sought from gatekeepers. Various methods will be used to de-identify any identifying information such as date of birth. A data-sharing agreement will be drawn up with each gatekeeper, and systems will be put into place to secure the information and prevent breach of confidentiality.

   This is a well-prepared application with attention to ethical issues.

   There are no points that require clarification

   IN VIEW OF THE ABOVE, PROF THOM RECOMMENDS THAT THE PROTOCOL BE APPROVED

Your response to the above queries raised would be appreciated on or before 18 July 2022.

Yours sincerely

MRS KIM ZARA MOTHIBA

For and on behalf of the Human Research Ethics Committee: (Medical)